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FREE PC and Mac Keyboard Reference

A practical quick-reference guide for Microsoft Excel

PC Keyboard

PC Keyboard – Excel Function Keys



The top row contains the **F1-F12** function keys. Excel commonly uses them directly or with **Ctrl**, **Shift**, or **Alt**.



Mac Keyboard

Important: Function-key behavior can vary by Excel version, operating system, keyboard layout, and Mac function-key settings. On many MacBooks, press **Fn** with **F1–F12** unless the F-keys are configured as standard function keys.

Mac Keyboard – Excel Function Keys



Mac keyboards add the Command (⌘), Option (⌥), Control (⌘), and **Fn** keys. Excel for Mac may require **Fn** to use **F1–F12**.



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IMPORTANT NOTE

Function-key behavior can vary by Excel version, operating system, keyboard layout, and Mac function-key settings.



Excel Version



Operating System



Keyboard Layout



Mac Function-Key Settings



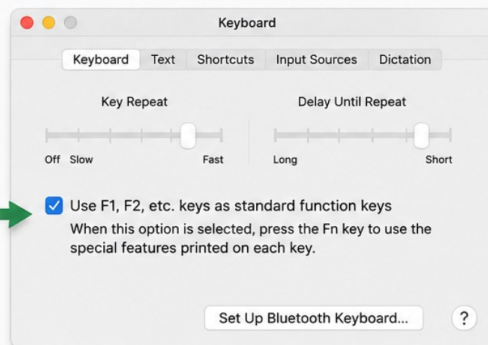
On many MacBooks, press **Fn** with **F1–F12** unless the F-keys are configured as standard function keys.

Use **Fn** + **F1–F12** to access standard function-key behavior in Excel.



Change this setting to use **F1–F12** as standard function keys.

On macOS:



TIP: If your F-keys are not working as expected in Excel, check your Mac function-key settings (**System Settings > Keyboard**) or try using **Fn + F1–F12**.



Excel Function Keys — Windows PC

Key	Excel action	Shortcut	Typical use
F1	Open Excel Help.	F1	Help/documentation
F2	Edit the active cell and place the insertion point in the cell/formula bar.	F2	Edit a cell
F3	Paste a defined name from the Paste Name dialog box.	F3	Defined names
F4	Repeat the last command when applicable; while editing a formula, cycle through relative/absolute/mixed references.	F4	Repeat / reference mode
F5	Open the Go To dialog box.	F5	Jump to a cell/range
F6	Switch focus among the worksheet, ribbon, task pane, and status bar.	F6 / Shift+F6	Navigate Excel UI
F7	Check spelling.	F7	Proofing
F8	Turn Extend Selection mode on/off.	F8	Extend a selection
F9	Calculate all worksheets in all open workbooks.	F9	Recalculate
F10	Turn KeyTips on/off for Ribbon access.	F10	Ribbon access
F11	Create a chart of the selected/current range on a separate chart sheet.	F11	Chart creation
F12	Open the Save As dialog box.	F12	Save As

Useful Windows combinations:

Windows shortcut	What it does
Shift+F9	Calculate the active worksheet only.
Ctrl+Alt+F9	Force calculation of all worksheets in all open workbooks.
Ctrl+Alt+Shift+F9	Full dependency check, then recalculate all cells.
Shift+F3	Open the Insert Function dialog box.
Alt+F1	Create an embedded chart from the current range.
Alt+F8	Open the Macro dialog box.
Alt+F11	Open the Visual Basic for Applications editor.
Alt+F12	Open Power Query Editor.

Excel Function Keys — Mac

Key	Excel action	Shortcut	Typical use
F1	Display the Help window.	F1	Help
F2	Edit the selected cell.	F2	Edit a cell
F3	Open the Formula Builder with Shift+F3; Cmd+F3 opens Define Name.	Shift+F3 / Cmd+F3	Functions / names
F4	Toggle formula reference style between absolute, relative, and mixed references.	F4 or Cmd+T	Formula references
F5	Display the Go To dialog box.	F5	Go To
F6	Switch focus among worksheet, ribbon, task pane, and status bar.	F6 / Shift+F6	Navigate Excel UI
F7	Check spelling.	F7	Proofing
F8	Extend the selection.	F8	Extend selection
F9	Calculate all open workbooks.	F9	Recalculate
F10	Maximize/restore the active window with Ctrl+F10 or Cmd+F10; Shift+F10 opens the context menu.	Ctrl/Cmd+F10; Shift+F10	Window/context menu
F11	Insert a new chart sheet.	F11	Chart sheet
F12	Display the Save As dialog box.	F12	Save As

Useful Mac function-key combinations

Mac shortcut	What it does
Shift+F2	Insert or edit a cell note.
Cmd+Shift+F2	Insert/reply to a threaded comment.
Option+F2	Open the Save dialog box.
Shift+F3	Open the Formula Builder.
Cmd+F3	Open Define Name.
Shift+F5	Open Find.
Option+F8	Open the Macro dialog box.
Option+F11	Open Visual Basic.
Option+F12	Open Power Query Editor.
Shift+F9	Calculate the active sheet.

NOTE: ⌘ Command = Cmd on Mac.

Useful Function Key Combinations for PC and Mac

Combination	Function	PC	Mac
Shift + F2	Insert or edit a cell comment / note.	Shift + F2	Shift + F2
Shift + F3	Insert a function dialog box.	Shift + F3	Shift + F3
Alt + F8	Open the Macro dialog box to run, edit, or delete macros.	Alt + F8	Option + F8
Shift + F11	Insert a new worksheet.	Shift + F11	Shift + F11
Ctrl + F1	Show or hide the Excel Ribbon.	Ctrl + F1	Cmd + Option + R



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PC vs. Mac Modifier Keys

Windows PC	Mac	Common Excel example
Ctrl	Command (⌘)	Ctrl+S → Cmd+S (Save)
Alt	Option (⌥)	Alt+F11 → Option+F11 (Visual Basic)
Shift	Shift	Shift+F9 → Shift+F9 (Calculate active sheet)
Windows key	Command (⌘)	OS-level key; not a general Excel replacement for Win
Function keys	F1–F12 (usually direct)	F1–F12; Fn may be required on MacBook keyboards

Examples from the Excel shortcuts discussed above

Action	PC	Mac
Save	Ctrl+S	Cmd+S
Undo	Ctrl+Z	Cmd+Z (Cmd+Y / Cmd+Shift+Z for redo)
Bold	Ctrl+B	Cmd+B
Select All	Ctrl+A	Cmd+A
Go To	F5	F5
Check spelling	F7	F7
Edit active cell	F2	F2
Formula references	F4	F4 or Cmd+T

Mac Function-Key Setting

Tip: On macOS, you can configure **F1**, **F2**, etc. to behave as standard function keys. If they are not configured that way, pressing **Fn** together with the function key may be necessary. Changing this setting affects the Mac generally, not only Excel.

Source and scope

This reference summarizes the Excel function-key shortcuts published by Microsoft for Excel for Microsoft 365 / current supported Mac versions and Windows. Shortcut behavior can change by version, keyboard layout, or system settings.

Primary source: Microsoft Support, “Keyboard shortcuts in Excel.”
<https://support.microsoft.com/en-US/Accessibility/excel/keyboard-shortcuts-in-excel>



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